

# María Eugenia Romero, MSc

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## PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Environmental scientist working at the science-policy interface across marine fisheries, biodiversity conservation, wetlands, and ocean governance. Technical profile focused on geospatial analysis of fishing activity, vessel monitoring data, fisheries statistics, remote sensing, GIS, R, Python, and large fisheries-related geospatial datasets.

## EDUCATION

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### **2026 | Specialization in GIS Spatial Analysis with Python & R — (starting Fall 2026)**

University of Washington

### **2021 | Diploma in Geomatic Tools Applied to the Environment**

National Commission for Space Activities of Argentina

### **2017 | Master in Water Management**

University of Buenos Aires

- Thesis: Potential effects of climate change on Buenos Aires coastal fisheries.

### **2012 | Environmental Science Degree**

University of Buenos Aires

- Thesis: Analysis of the selective predation of *Odontesthes bonariensis* on zooplankton.

## TECHNICAL SKILLS AND LANGUAGES

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- Geographic information systems and remote sensing: QGIS, SNAP, GIS-based spatial analysis.
- Data analysis and visualization: R, Python, Tableau, Power BI.
- Policy and technical areas: marine fisheries management, vessel monitoring data, fisheries statistics, bycatch mitigation, IUU fishing, BBNJ, MPAs/OECMs, marine plastic litter, aquatic biodiversity, wetlands, and environmental impact assessment.
- Languages: Spanish: native speaker. English: TOEFL iBT 91.

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

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### **2026-present | Aquatic Technical Specialist**

University of Virginia

- Provide daily husbandry and technical support for aquatic research species.
- Support operation, monitoring, and maintenance of aquatic life-support systems and associated facility equipment.
- Assist with facility operations, animal care standards, investigator support, and routine aquatic system workflows.

### **2022-2025 | Fisheries Management Coordinator**

Undersecretariat of Fisheries | Fisheries Management Coordination - Fisheries Planning Directorate

- Integrated scientific and technical information to support decision-making on marine fisheries management, fisheries administration, and sector development measures.
- Worked on bottom-trawl footprint assessments, spatial analyses of fishing activity, and geospatial evaluation of fisheries-related datasets using GIS, R, Python, fisheries statistics, and vessel monitoring data.
- Prepared and reviewed technical reports, policy documents, and interinstitutional inputs linked to national fisheries regulations and Argentina's international commitments.
- Contributed to policy and technical processes related to IUU fishing, the BBNJ Agreement, OECMs, marine litter, bycatch mitigation, and ecosystem-based fisheries management.
- Participated in international fisheries policy forums, including the FAO Committee on Fisheries Sub-Committee on Fisheries Management, as part of the Argentine delegation.

### **2008-2022 | Technical Specialist / Environmental Management**

Ministry of Environment and Sustainable Development, Argentina

### **2015-2022 | National Directorate of Environmental Management of Water and Aquatic Ecosystems**

Technical assistance in conservation and management of aquatic and marine biodiversity.

- Contributed to the National Action Plan for the Conservation and Management of Chondrichthyans (Sharks, Rays and Chimaeras) in the Argentine Republic.
- Contributed to the National Action Plan to Reduce the Interaction of Seabirds with Fisheries in the Argentine Republic (PAN-Birds).

- Contributed to the National Action Plan to Reduce Interactions between Marine Mammals and Fisheries in the Argentine Republic (PAN-Mammals).
- Contributed to the National Action Plan for the Conservation of Sea Turtles (PAN-Turtles), including the National Program to Reduce Interactions between Sea Turtles and Fisheries in Argentina.
- Participated in the Working Commission to Strengthen Bycatch Reduction Measures in Fisheries (CT Bycatch), supporting interinstitutional work on incidental catch reduction and ecosystem-based fisheries management.
- Technical assistance in the evaluation of environmental impact studies, including offshore seismic exploration.
- Participation in marine litter projects.
- Contributed to the development and implementation of the National Wetland Inventory, including planning and execution of field sampling campaigns in diverse wetland ecosystems.
- Harmful algal blooms / eutrophication-related monitoring in the Río de la Plata region
- Technical participation in projects with international financing (GCP/ARG/025/GFF Governance Strengthening for the Management and Protection of Coastal-Marine Biodiversity in Key Ecological Areas and the Implementation of the Ecosystem Approach to Fisheries).
- Technical Coordinator of the Network for Evaluation and Monitoring of Aquatic Ecosystems (REM.AQUA) - CONICET. <https://remaqua.conicet.gov.ar/estructura/>

#### **2008-2015 | Directorate of Prevention and Environmental Recomposition**

- Control inspections, including sampling of liquid effluents; verification of industrial sewer and storm drain plans; verification of liquid effluent treatment plants.
- Development of technical inspection reports, analysis protocols, and files.

#### **2009-2020 | Assistant Teacher**

Faculty of Agronomy, University of Buenos Aires

- Assisted in the subject of Aquatic Ecology.
- Participated in teaching Fisheries Management and Restoration of Aquatic Ecosystems.
- Conducted laboratory work, including identification and analysis of zooplankton, phytoplankton, and benthic macroinvertebrates; fish stomach content analysis; and extraction of fish otoliths.
- Assisted in the delivery of the Zooplankton Study Methodology Workshop.
- Member of research projects (UBACYT).
- Assisted undergraduate thesis students.

### **VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCE**

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#### **2025-present | Rivanna Conservation Alliance**

- Watershed Educational Field Trips.
- Benthic monitoring: collection, sorting, and field identification of benthic macroinvertebrates as bioindicators of stream health.

### **COURSES**

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#### **2010 | Aquatic Sediment Chemistry**

University of Buenos Aires

#### **2011 | Methodologies for the Determination of Fishing Stocks**

University of Buenos Aires

#### **2013 | Bioecology of Commercial Fish of Argentina**

University of Buenos Aires

#### **2018 | Introduction to SAR Remote Sensing**

National Commission for Space Activities of Argentina

#### **2019 | Descriptive Multivariate Analysis in Biological and Social Research**

University of Buenos Aires

#### **2020 | Geomatic Tools Applied to the Environment**

National Commission for Space Activities of Argentina

#### **2020 | Introduction to Google Earth Engine**

National Institute of Agricultural Technology of Argentina

#### **2021 | Mapping and Monitoring Lakes and Reservoirs with Satellite Observations**

NASA, ARSET

#### **2021 | Remote Sensing Applied to the Color of the Ocean**

National Commission for Space Activities of Argentina

#### **2021 | Collect Earth: Assessment of Land Use Changes**

FAO

## **2021 | Remote Observation of Marine and Coastal Waters Focused on the Argentine Sea**

National Commission for Space Activities of Argentina

## **2021 | Professional Training of Fishery Observers: Shrimp Fishery, Hake Fishery, Crab Fishery**

National Technological University

## **2024 | Ocean Governance Capacity Building Training Program**

Environment and International Law Practice Group of the World Bank

## **2024 | Regional Workshop for Latin America on the BBNJ Agreement (Chile)**

Division for Ocean Affairs and the Law of the Sea - Office of Legal Affairs - United Nations

## **2025 | Regional Collaboration to Fight IUU Fishing in South America (US)**

Florida International University

## **ADDITIONAL TRAINING**

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### **Dec 2025-May 2026 | Mentee - Impact Evaluation Mentoring Program**

Society for Conservation Biology

- 6-month mentoring program.

### **Jul 2026-Aug 2026 | Climate Change AI 2026 Summer School — (starting Summer 2026)**

- 5-week training.

### **Aug 2026 | Visualizations with Python — (starting Fall 2026)**

OceanTeacher Global Academy

- 3-week training

## **PUBLICATIONS**

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### **Peer-reviewed journal articles**

- Rennella, A. M., Geronazzo, M. D., Romero, M. E., Boveri, M., & Rosso, J. J. 2019. Hydrological variability, zooplankton availability and the shift between planktivore-benthivore feeding behaviour in the visual predator fish, *Odontesthes bonariensis*. *Environmental Biology of Fishes*, 1-13.
- Pascual, M., Barral, M., Poca, M., Pessacg, N., García Silva, L., Albariño, R., Romero, M. E., & Jobbágy, E. 2021. Continental aquatic ecosystems and their services: Approaches and real-world application scenarios. *Ecología Austral*, Vol. 31. [In Spanish].

### **Book chapter**

- Romero, M. E., & Volpedo, A. V. 2017. Influence of climate change on a transboundary fishery resource: the case of the whitemouth croaker. In M. Pinto, J. Estrella, & A. Gennari (Eds.), *Agua y Sociedad*, pp. 291-321. Buenos Aires: Universidad Nacional de Cuyo. [Original title in Spanish].

### **Published conference proceedings**

- Romero, M. E., Tombesi, M. L., & Navarro, G. 2025. Other Effective Area-Based Conservation Measures (OECMs): Closing gaps between sustainable management and biodiversity conservation. In *Proceedings of the XIX Scientific Symposium of the Joint Technical Commission of the Maritime Front (CTMFM)*, Colonia, Uruguay, November 2022. *Frente Marítimo* 27: 91-100. [In Spanish].

## **SELECTED TECHNICAL REPORTS AND POLICY DOCUMENTS**

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### **Authored and co-authored technical reports**

- Aguirre, L. E., Bonicatto, A., Castellani, B., Fuchs, D., Gonzalez Naya, M. J., Mantinian, J. E., Monsalvo, M., Navarro, G., Panné Huidobro, S., Piedrabuena, C., Romero, M. E., Rozycki, V., Saglietti, D., & Wicki, G. 2025. Fisheries. In *State of the Environment Report 2024*, pp. 412-429. Subsecretariat of Environment, Government of Argentina. [In Spanish].
- Romero, M. E., Monsalvo, M., Martínez Puljak, G., & Navarro, G. 2025. Spatial distribution of landings by the Argentine commercial fleet in 2024. DPP Report No. 6/2025. Fisheries Planning Directorate, Undersecretariat of Aquatic Resources and Fisheries, Argentina. [In Spanish].
- Bernasconi, F., Monsalvo, M., Romero, M. E., & Navarro, G. 2022. Chondrichthyans: analysis of landing declarations during 2010-2020. DPP Report No. 08/2022. Fisheries Planning Directorate, Undersecretariat of Fisheries and Aquaculture, Argentina. [In Spanish].

### Technical coordination, review, and institutional reporting

- Signed as Fisheries Management Coordinator. 2025. Current geospatial fisheries regulations in the Argentine EEZ and Common Fishing Zone, 2023. DPP-DNCyFP Report No. 01/2025. Undersecretariat of Aquatic Resources and Fisheries, Argentina. [In Spanish; not listed as author].
- Listed national technical contributor. 2024. Argentina Annual Report 2024 to the Inter-American Convention for the Protection and Conservation of Sea Turtles. Inter-American Convention for the Protection and Conservation of Sea Turtles. [In Spanish].

### SELECTED WORKSHOPS, WORKING GROUPS, AND INTERNATIONAL POLICY PROCESSES

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- Member of the Argentine delegation, virtual participation. 2024. FAO Committee on Fisheries, First Session of the Sub-Committee on Fisheries Management. Rome, Italy, 15-18 January 2024.
- Participant and contributor to the Objective 4 session. 2021. Fourth Follow-up Workshop of the National Action Plan for the Conservation and Management of Chondrichthyans (Sharks, Rays and Chimaeras) in Argentina (PAN-Sharks). Virtual meeting, 19, 20, 26, and 27 October 2021.
- Participant. 2023. Workshop on Good Fishing Practices and Third Working Commission Meeting to Strengthen Bycatch Reduction Measures in Fisheries. Puerto Madryn, Argentina, 9-10 May 2023.
- Participant. 2023. Second Follow-up Workshop of the National Action Plan to Reduce Interactions between Marine Mammals and Fisheries (PAN-Mammals). Buenos Aires, Argentina, 24-25 August 2023.

### PARTICIPATION IN CONFERENCES

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- IV Binational Ecology Meeting. Presentation: Consequences of selective predation of *Odontesthes bonariensis* juveniles on the seasonal dynamics of zooplankton in the coastal zone of Pampas lagoons.
- 25th Argentine Ecology Meeting. Presentation: Seasonal dynamics of the diet of a cohort of juvenile silversides as a function of the zooplankton structure in the coastal zone.
- 7th Congress of Ecology and Management of Pampas Aquatic Ecosystems. Presentation: Influence of hydrology on the trophic behavior of the pampas silverside (*Odontesthes bonariensis*).
- 6th Argentine Congress of Limnology. Presentation: Evaluation of the effects of water turbidity on the predation of two species of zooplanktivorous fish.
- VIII Congress of Ecology and Management of Pampas Aquatic Ecosystems. Presentation: Variation of zooplankton in the littoral zone of Pampas lagoons along a gradient of predator abundance. A photo from the end of summer.
- Interdisciplinary Program of the University of Buenos Aires on Climate Change. Presentation: Potential effects of climate change on Buenos Aires coastal fisheries.
- IX Congress of Ecology and Management of Pampas Aquatic Ecosystems. Presentation: Effects of the presence of the shortfin on the trophic behavior of juvenile silversides in Pampas lagoons.
- VIII Argentine Congress of Limnology. Presentation: Network for Evaluation and Monitoring of Aquatic Ecosystems (REM.AQUA).
- 19th Scientific Symposium of the Joint Technical Commission of the Maritime Front (CTMFM). Presentation: Other Effective Area-Based Conservation Measures - OECMs: closing gaps between sustainable management and conservation of biodiversity.